

Delaware County Budget Hearings September 24th 2024 Segment #1

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vXtmQzlsarA
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Delaware County Council Budget Meeting Report

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The Delaware County Council convened a budget meeting [00:00:17](#) to review funds under the maximum levy, department salary requests, and local income tax (LIT) distributions.
- **Attendance:** Council members present included Bill, Matt, Ryan, Eugene, and other participating council members. Department heads and county officials (including Sheriff and Highway representatives) also participated. Presiding officer duties were managed collaboratively among council leadership.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Review of Analysis Documents:** The council reviewed freshly distributed comparative analysis spreadsheets detailing requests for 2024 and 2025 across funds governed by the maximum levy (specifically Fund 1000 County General, Fund 1135 Cumulative Bridge, Fund 1159 Health, and Fund 1224 Reassessment).

- **Approval of Prior Business:** The council worked through validation processes to align notes with the auditor's office following previous budget sessions.
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3. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:01:00 Fund Analysis & Max Levy Budget Cuts

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council leadership and the auditor's office.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The council examined various percentage-cut scenarios (reducing midpoint proposals by 1% to 5%) to meet mandatory budget targets. Discussions centered on operating balances, cash flow lows occurring annually in April and October, and allowable adjustments under the max levy. The council debated whether a \$6 million operating balance target was necessary or if cash flow management could allow for flexibility.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational review and working deliberation; no final roll call vote was taken at this stage.

01:12:00 Highway & Cumulative Bridge Salary Adjustments (Fund 1135 & Fund 1176)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Highway representatives (Tommy and Carrie).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Department heads noted that many frontline workers (truck drivers, equipment operators, and mechanics) received no raises under initial salary study allocations. The council discussed adding a \$2,000 salary increase across the board for frozen positions in the highway and bridge funds to improve retention and account for in-house paving savings. Specific focus was given to adjusting the office manager's position to midpoint parity.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Consensus to incorporate \$2,000 adjustments for affected non-exempt highway/bridge workers and adjust office manager lines, pending final auditor verification. Approved by Voice Vote.

02:34:55 Statewide 911 Budget Adjustments (Fund 4703)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fred (911 Director).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Fred requested the council restore salary lines for five 911 supervisors to requested levels (increasing from proposed 65k to 67k) following exemptions agreed upon two years prior. It was noted that health insurance savings from unfilled positions would more than offset the \$2,000 salary adjustments.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to restore supervisory salary figures.

02:40:30 Jail Commander Salary Adjustment (Fund 1000)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** The Sheriff.

- **Deliberation Summary:** The Sheriff requested an adjustment for the jail captain/jail commander position to be set at an exempt salary of \$70,000 to prevent a pay cut compared to prior earnings with overtime. Corresponding reductions were proposed in overtime lines.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to adjust the captain/jail commander salary to \$70,000 with offsetting overtime reductions.
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(No formal public hearing comments from general citizens were logged during this internal budget working session, though department heads and officials spoke as noted above.)

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff & Board Announcements:** The council addressed upcoming deadlines for budget adoption, noting potential needs to verify figures with the auditor's office and check statutory extension processes with state officials.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was recessed at 02:58:09 with official plans to reconvene on **Tuesday, October 1, 2024, at 3:30 p.m.**
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